

Cheaper brands often get a bad rap when compared to items like dentist recommended Crest and Colgate, but it's worth trying a few different labels just to see what you like best. Sometimes, the less expensive and generic option can be a surprising win!

In the same fashion, don't be afraid to do a little product experimenting. Sure, household items can be used as intended, but they can also serve an entirely new purpose as well.

For instance:

- Conditioner is a great alternative to shaving cream
- Shea butter is a wonderful natural moisturizer
- Baking soda works well in lieu of regular toothpaste

A quick search on Pinterest will give you hundreds of DIY options and homemade mixes to try. I've even seen recipes for homemade deodorant, although to be honest, that one scares me a little bit! You'll tell me if I smell, right?

5. MAKE IT LAST LONGER

You'll get many more applications out of your toiletries if you cut off the tops of squeeze bottles or add a little water to your body wash to get that last little bit out. Joseph and I have an ongoing toothpaste war to see how long we can go before throwing the tube away, and sometimes it gets pretty competitive. But then again, it's amazing how many days, sometimes weeks, we're able to go before replacing the nearly empty tube!

In regards to razors, here's how to extend the life of your blades:

- Dry blades thoroughly after using to prevent rust (blot dry with a towel or blow dry)